

Waves in a ripple tank and on a string (RP)

Waves
Paper 2 · Combined and Separate
8 questions

Cover the answers. Answer each question out loud or on paper, then check. Tick the ones you know. Learn the 4 starred (★) questions first.

	QUESTION	ANSWER	✓
1	Name three properties of a wave that can be measured in a ripple tank.	Frequency, wavelength and speed	☐
2	A ripple tank casts bright and dark lines on the screen. State what they show.	Bright lines: peaks. Dark lines: troughs.	☐
3 ★	Describe how waves are produced in a ripple tank.	A motor makes a dipper vibrate up and down on the water surface.	☐
4 ★	Describe how to measure the frequency of waves in a ripple tank.	Count the waves passing a point in 10 s and divide by 10.	☐
5 ★	Describe two ways to find the speed of the waves in a ripple tank.	Frequency × wavelength Or: time a wave over a measured distance, then distance ÷ time	☐
6	Describe how to find the frequency of a wave on a string.	Read it from the signal generator.	☐
7 ★	Describe how to measure the wavelength of a wave on a string.	Measure the length of several loops and divide by the number of loops. Wavelength = 2 × the length of one loop.	☐
8	Describe how to find the speed of a wave on a string.	Multiply the frequency by the wavelength.	☐